

Christopher Smothers

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Engineering leader & founder. Built and led product engineering teams at two venture-backed companies (one acquisition) as a hands-on player-coach; now applying that leadership to an org of AI agents.

EXPERIENCE

xNet · Creator

2026 – Present

Building xnet.fyi, an open-source local-first platform, by running a team of AI agents the way I ran engineering teams: written specs and explorations before implementation, CI quality gates, a visual changelog to review every change, and 11,000+ tests across 50+ packages. The management problems (delegation, review, quality bars, velocity) are the same; the reports are agents.

Sabbatical · rest, independent study & community building

2022 – 2026

A deliberate break after a decade of back-to-back startups. Co-founded a nonprofit community center in Berlin.

Homebase · Co-founder & CTO

2020 – 2022

Raised \$500K+, hired and led a small team building a shared local-first data layer for web apps. Open-sourced homebase-react; endorsed by the founder of Firebase and Notion's founding engineer.

Shortcut · Engineering Manager & Tech Lead, Docs

2019 – 2020

Hired as the first full-stack engineer; promoted to lead a new product team within three months.

- Built and led the Docs team (four engineers, three reporting to me, two of whom I hired, plus a designer, PM, and marketer), owning hiring, onboarding, 1:1s, and delivery as a hands-on player-coach.
- Earned the promotion by writing the collaborative-editing trade-off analysis that became the company's docs strategy, then designed the architecture for Shortcut Docs, a real-time collaborative editor integrated with existing project-management data.
- Took the team from zero to an MVP in customers' hands in six months while standing up its CI/CD and delivery process; contributed daily in React and Clojure throughout.

Spacious · Co-founder & CTO · acquired by WeWork

2015 – 2018

Scaled the company from 2 people to 90 across 25 locations in NY and SF while raising \$14M, with customer NPS of ~80.

- Hired and led the entire 9-person product org (six engineers, two designers, and a data scientist, with all engineers and the data scientist reporting to me) from first interview loop through the acquisition.
- Directed delivery of the full product surface on a real-time GraphQL API: iPhone & Android apps, iPad kiosks, an admin portal, the marketing site, and time-and-attendance and accounting integrations.
- Owned technology end to end (data warehouse and ETL pipelines, plus Wi-Fi and internet across all 25 locations) with an ops discipline where the worst outage in four years was AWS S3 taking down half the internet.

Press: Forbes 30 Under 30, The New York Times, Bloomberg, Fast Company, NPR, TechCrunch, Fortune, and others.

EDUCATION

Brown University

2006 – 2011

Visual Storytelling, an independent concentration combining computer science, visual art, and writing. Took 2010 off to farm and meditate with monks.

LEADERSHIP & SKILLS

Hiring & team building · Mentorship · Delivery & CI/CD · Incident discipline · TypeScript · React · Node · Clojure(Script) · GraphQL · Local-first sync